VXIII

MARKET RESEARCH

STAGE 2 · WHAT MEN AND WOMEN BUY · OCTOBER 2026

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This document sets out what men and women buy in sunglasses: the shapes, the frame colours, the lens colours, the materials and the prices. It is the evidence for the mood board, the constructions and the colourways that follow.

01 HOW TO READ THE EVIDENCE

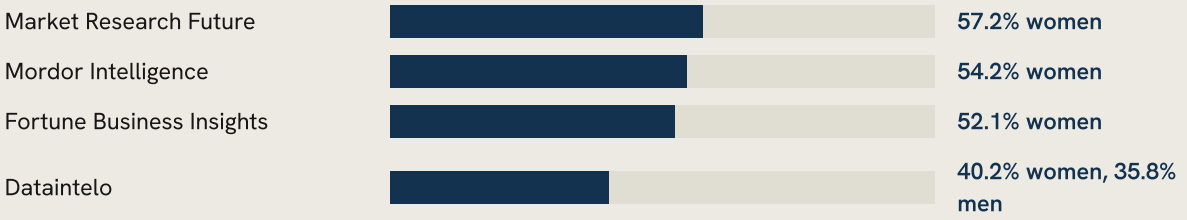
Every finding carries a grade for the strength of its source. Decisions in later stages lean on grade A wherever it exists and use grades B and C only to set direction.

GRADE	SOURCE TYPE	HOW WE USE IT
A	Consumer surveys with a stated method, from The Vision Council and Morning Consult	Firm evidence. Used to set shape and lens decisions.
B	Commercial market reports from research publishers	Used for market size and segment share. Figures differ between publishers, so we quote the range.
C	Retailer listings, editors' picks and trend articles	Direction only. Used for colour and styling, where no survey data is public.

The full tables broken down by gender sit inside paid reports, which we have not bought. Section 09 lists what they would add.

02 WHO BUYS SUNGLASSES

Women account for the larger share of sunglasses spending in three of the four market reports we found. One publisher places men and women much closer together.



GRADE B. SHARE OF GLOBAL SUNGLASSES REVENUE HELD BY WOMEN, 2025. DATAINTELO COUNTS A SEPARATE UNISEX SEGMENT OF 24.0%.

Polarised lenses are the norm. Two publishers place polarised sunglasses at 75.4% and 81.0% of the market in 2025, and a third gives a much lower 42.3%.

03 WHY PEOPLE BUY

In the 2023 Vision Council survey of US adults, carried out by Morning Consult, fit and comfort came first among the factors behind a purchase, ahead of price.



GRADE A. THE VISION COUNCIL, FOCUSED INSIGHTS 2023: SUNGLASSES SNAPSHOT, MAY 2023. FACTORS NAMED AS IMPORTANT WHEN BUYING.

The same survey found that 72% of adults wear sunglasses mainly to see better in bright sun and 62% wear them for UV protection. Seven in ten wear sunglasses always, most of the time or some of the time outdoors.

04 SHAPES

Asked about sunglasses, US adults named two shapes well ahead of all others. This is the strongest evidence in the document.



GRADE A. THE VISION COUNCIL, FOCUSED INSIGHTS 2023: SUNGLASSES SNAPSHOT. PREFERRED SUNGLASSES SHAPE, US ADULTS.

The 2024 Vision Council survey of 2,200 US adults covers all eyewear. It found rectangular (77%) and square (66%) frames the most popular overall, with cat eye and browline favoured by women and aviator and rimless favoured by men.

WEARER	SHAPES FAVOURED	SOURCE
Men	Square, aviator, rimless	A Vision Council 2023 and 2024
Women	Cat eye and browline, on a base of square	A Vision Council 2023 and 2024

Trend coverage for 2025 and 2026 agrees with the surveys and adds detail. It names the softened square and the rounded rectangle as the leading oversized shapes, hexagonal and octagonal metal frames as a rising geometric style, updated cat eyes for women and a return of rimless and semi-rimless titanium.

GRADE C. FANSU OPTICAL, TITANIUM FRAMES 2026. ALL ABOUT VISION, MEN'S STYLES 2025. THE ZOE REPORT, SPRING 2025.

05 LENS COLOUR

Black and grey lenses were preferred by 60% of US adults in the 2023 Vision Council survey, which makes grey the safest lens in the range.



GRADE A. THE VISION COUNCIL, FOCUSED INSIGHTS 2023: SUNGLASSES SNAPSHOT.

WEARER	LENSES THAT SELL	EVIDENCE
Men	Grey and black first, then green and brown. Mirrored and polarised lenses are often requested.	A grey overall. C Quay lens count, black 104. WMP Eyewear bestsellers. All About Vision.
Women	Brown gradient first, then grey gradient, rose and copper gradients, and amber. The gradient lens is the clearest difference from men.	C REI and OutdoorGearLab both pick a brown gradient lens as their top women's frame. EZContacts and The Zoe Report report the gradient revival.

06 FRAME COLOUR

Black leads frame colour overall. The 2024 Vision Council survey found that tortoise, multicolour and clear frames have stronger appeal among younger buyers and among people who buy eyewear without a prescription, which describes most sunglasses buyers.

GRADE A. THE VISION COUNCIL, FOCUSED INSIGHTS 2024: FRAME TRENDS. NO PERCENTAGES ARE PUBLISHED FOR COLOUR.

Men

A men's bestseller page from Quay counts its frames by colour. The count shows what the retailer stocks among its bestsellers and gives direction, though it is not a sales figure.



GRADE C. QUAY, MEN'S BESTSELLERS, FRAMES LISTED BY COLOUR.

For metal frames, the reference pairing is the gold aviator with a green lens, which retailers stock across every size of the Ray-Ban Aviator.

Women

Tortoiseshell is the colour most often named for women in 2025, followed by brown frames with brown gradient lenses. Gold appears mainly on metal frames and as an accent. Transparent frames in soft pink and smoky grey continue to sell, and red-based tortoise and amber tones are the newer additions.

GRADE C. EZCONTACTS, WOMEN'S SUNGLASSES 2025. THE ZOE REPORT, SPRING 2025. REI AND OUTDOORGEARLAB EDITORS' PICKS.

07 MATERIALS AND PRICE

Acetate is the most preferred frame material overall at 48% in the 2024 Vision Council survey. Titanium is positioned as the premium metal by retailers, and frames that pair titanium with acetate are described as the current direction in premium eyewear.

GRADE A FOR ACETATE, VISION COUNCIL 2024. GRADE C FOR TITANIUM POSITIONING, FANSU OPTICAL 2026.

Price of titanium sunglasses at independent premium brands

BRAND	RETAIL PRICE, USD	NOTE
Oliver Peoples	525 to 1,644	Titanium models. Harrods lists one at 525 and a retailer lists the TK-8 at 1,644.
Jacques Marie Mage	About 900 to 1,600	Most sunglass styles sit between 900 and 1,100. Limited titanium pieces reach 1,496.
Lindberg	About 400 to 1,400	Prices found are mainly for optical frames.
Mykita	About 569 to 839	Mostly stainless steel and its own Mylon material, with little titanium.

GRADE C. RETAILER PAGES AND BRAND GUIDES, PRICES AS LISTED IN 2025 AND 2026. PRICES VARY BY RETAILER AND MODEL.

The independent premium segment begins at about 500 dollars for a titanium sunglass. These brands sell on material and construction and spend little on logos, which is the same ground VXIII stands on.

08 WHAT THIS MEANS FOR VXIII

I am setting the following as the brief for the mood board, the constructions and the colourways. Each point rests on the evidence above.

AREA	DIRECTION
Halite, men	The three concepts will start from the square, the aviator and the rimless frame, the three shapes men favour. At least one concept will be a true square, since square leads the market for both men and women.
Fleur, women	The three concepts will start from the cat eye, the soft oversized square and a clear acetate frame. Women favour the cat eye and browline, and clear frames appeal to younger buyers.
Halite colours	One black frame with a grey lens is required. The other three will come from tortoise, brown, gold with a green lens, and silver or gunmetal, all with solid lenses.
Fleur colours	One gold frame with a brown gradient lens and one tortoise frame are required. The other two will come from black with a grey gradient, a clear or rose transparent frame, and amber.
Lenses	Every lens is polarised. Grey is the base lens of the range. Gradients are reserved for Fleur.
Fit	Fit and comfort is the first reason to buy, so the construction stage will specify adjustable nose pads, temple length and fit ranges for every model.
Materials	Titanium carries every structure. Acetate is used where it adds colour or clarity, in tortoise and clear above all.
Price	The work assumes a frame priced in the independent premium segment, from about 500 dollars. The final price is set in the business plan.

Every name in the colourways stage will still come from salt. The research decides the colour, and the story decides what it is called.

09 GAPS IN THE EVIDENCE

GAP	WHAT WOULD CLOSE IT
Frame and lens colour split by gender, with percentages	The Vision Council Focused inSights+ data tables, broken down by age, gender, income and region. The 2024 Frame Trends report is listed at 2,000 dollars.
Unit sales by colourway	Retail panel data from Circana, or bestseller rankings from a marketplace.
Buyers outside the United States	The surveys above cover US adults. A survey of our first market would confirm the direction.

10 SOURCES

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- OutdoorGearLab, best sunglasses. outdoorgearlab.com
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- Harrods, Edward Beiner, eye-oo, Specs Collective and View Eyewear, retail price pages.